Tim Everard

Live Events and Operations Leader

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PROFILE

Events and operations leader with 15 years' experience, from theatre lighting and TV studio builds to heading Esports Operations at BLAST. Led a six-person department delivering a large live events portfolio: 60+ flagship events and 300+ qualifiers in 13 countries, in person and online, with 2,000+ freelancers and €12m+ in budgets. Experienced in managing suppliers and freelancers, controlling budgets, setting standards and documentation, and building the tools that let a team deliver consistently. Comfortable costing and pitching new events with commercial teams and stakeholders. Having worked every side of a live show, on the ground and in the office, I focus on making event day run smoothly for the people on site.

60+	300+	13	2,000+	€12m+
flagship events	qualifiers	countries	freelancers	in budgets

EXPERIENCE

Head of Esports Operations — Jun 2023 – Oct 2026
BLAST

- Led a six-person department running the events portfolio across every BLAST ecosystem, including CS2, Dota 2, Brawl Stars, Fortnite, Rocket League and Rainbow Six
- Rebuilt how the department works, with clearer ownership, accountability and proper documentation
- Wrote the business case for a departmental OPEX budget covering equipment renewal, software and cross-event costs
- Costed and pitched new events with the product and commercial teams
- Brought Team Operations into the department, so all online and offline player management and support sat with one team
- Designed and built the department's own tools for event and equipment tracking, freelancer calendars, bookings and contracting, and event budgets and deadlines
- Set technical requirements for commercial partnerships

KEY SKILLS

Events and leadership
Events portfolio delivery, team leadership, restructuring, process improvement, standards

Suppliers and freelancers
Vendor management, freelancer booking, contracting and payments, rotas

Commercial and finance
Budgets, pitch costings, invoices, business cases, stakeholder management

Event management
Event logistics, site visits, bootcamps, in-person and online events

Systems and tooling
Airtable, Google Workspace, Microsoft Office

Broadcast and technical
Studio builds, Blackmagic, vMix, Ross Video, lighting, audio

Safeguarding and safety
Designated Safeguarding Lead, first aider, fire marshal

CERTIFICATIONS

First Aid at Work	2022
Safeguarding Lead (DSL)	2021
Working at Heights	2018
Moving Head Maintenance	2018
Manual Handling	2018
Fire Marshal	2018
PAT Testing	2016
IPAF	2012

References available on request.

Tournament Operations Manager

Jan 2020 – Jun 2023

BLAST · Contractor to Mar 2021, then permanent

- Managed event equipment and staffing budgets across CS:GO, Dota 2, Apex Legends, FIFA, Fortnite and Rainbow Six
- Booked and managed freelancers for internal, external and online productions
- Approved equipment and staffing invoices, and decided when to hire, buy or repair kit
- Main tournament-level contact for FACEIT, ESIC and BLAST Premier teams
- Arranged venues and equipment for team bootcamps
- Designated Safeguarding Lead and first aider at live events

Broadcast Freelancer

Jan 2018 – Jan 2020

Self-employed · Alongside Jam Television

- Crewed broadcasts and live events for clients including BLAST Pro Series, ESL UK and ESL Germany, BBC, Sky Sports, ITV, Immediate Media, NATS, Big Ben (WRC), Altitude Angels and Create Broadcasting
- Worked in the gallery as technical director, producer and graphics operator on live shows
- Consulted on production and technical setups for clients

Broadcast and Studio Manager

Mar 2018 – Jan 2019

Jam Television · Birmingham

- Designed a multi-camera TV studio from scratch, bought the equipment, and managed installation and testing
- Controlled the studio budget, including equipment purchasing
- Hired freelancers and ran staff rotas to keep a 24-hour TV channel on air
- Managed suppliers and invoice approval, and trained staff on equipment and workflows

Production Manager

Jul 2015 – Dec 2017

ESL UK · Leicester

- Built the technical infrastructure for two ESL UK studios and managed production for both
- Managed production at external events including MCM, EGX and Formula E
- Controlled production budgets and purchased studio and event equipment
- Hired freelance crew, managed rotas and supervised internal and external staff on live shows
- Ran equipment hire, installation, testing and maintenance, and trained crew

Senior Lighting and Event Technician

Jun 2012 – Jun 2015

Dorking Halls · Casual Technician Mar 2010 – Jan 2011

- Controlled the equipment and training budget, and ran in-house lighting training
- Set up and ran touring and in-house performances
- Head of lighting for The Darkness's support act, support lighting engineer for Enter Shikari, head of audio and lighting for Lee Mack, and comedy tours with Jimmy Carr, Dara Ó Briain and Ed Byrne
- Covered whatever the show needed, working as audio engineer, stage hand or stage manager
- Maintained specialist kit for a theatre and two cinemas; carried out PAT testing